English Week 3 plus: language and symbolism (written)

Ember · Real AQA GCSE English Language question (Paper 1, Q2) · about 20 minutes Date: _____

Skill: Quote, effect, So What. Short quotes. Say what the words make us picture or feel, explain *how*, then say what the thing comes to stand for.

AQA English Language 8700/1, November 2024, Q02 **[8 marks]**

Part A (about 12 minutes). Look in detail at this extract, from lines 8 to 14 of the source:

> Behind a tall, rusting gate, Foxcote Manor erupts from the undergrowth, as if a geological heave has lifted it from the woodland floor. A wrecked beauty, the old house's windows blink drunkenly in the evening sunlight. Colossal trees overhang a sweep of red-tiled roof that sags in the middle, like a snapped spine, so the chimneys tilt at odd angles. Ivy suckers up the timber and brick-gabled façade, dense, bristling, alive with dozens of tiny darting birds, a billowing veil of bees. It's as far from the Harringtons' elegant London townhouse as Rita could possibly imagine.

How does the writer use language here to describe Foxcote Manor?

You could include the writer's choice of: • words and phrases • language features and techniques • sentence forms.

Part B: the same question, your book (about 8 minutes)

Pick one object or place in *Tsunami Girl* that you decided was a symbol in Week 3. Copy one short quote about it from your notes or the book.

Symbol: _____ Quote: “_____”

Question: How does the writer use language to describe the _____?

Self-check (5 min)

□ Part A covers at least three different quotes.

□ Each quote is a few words, and each has an effect and a **how** (…so…).

□ At least one point reaches a So What: what the house stands for.

□ Part B uses a real quote from Tsunami Girl, not a summary.

□ Reflection: which quote was hardest to explain, and why?

AQA mark scheme: November 2024, Paper 1, Q02 (8 marks)

- **Level 4 (7–8): perceptive, detailed.** Analyses the effects of the writer's choices of language; selects a range of judicious textual detail; makes sophisticated and accurate use of subject terminology.
- **Level 3 (5–6): clear, relevant.** Explains clearly the effects of the writer's choices of language; selects a range of relevant textual detail; makes clear and accurate use of subject terminology.
- **Level 2 (3–4): some, attempts.** Attempts to comment on the effect of language; selects some appropriate textual detail; makes some use of subject terminology, mainly appropriately.
- **Level 1 (1–2): simple, limited.** Offers simple comment on the effect of language; selects simple references or textual details; makes simple use of subject terminology, not always appropriately.

AQA's list of what students may write about: verbs 'erupts', 'lifted' (intimidating presence) · juxtaposition 'wrecked beauty' (decline) · personification 'windows blink drunkenly' (lack of balance) · natural imagery 'colossal trees', 'ivy suckers up' (neglect, nature taking control) · simile 'sags in the middle, like a snapped spine' (extent of the damage) · listing 'dense, bristling, alive' (nature has taken over) · contrast 'elegant' and 'wrecked' (London townhouse versus Foxcote Manor).

Part A level: _____ Part B level: _____

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